

Mesopotamia & Sumer -- Key Words (Answer key)

Name: _____

Word bank: alliance · artisan · city-state · cradle of civilization · cuneiform · epic · Fertile Crescent · hereditary · irrigation · Mesopotamia · monarchy · polytheism · scribe · silt · surplus · ziggurat

Write the word from the word bank that matches each meaning.

1. "the land between the rivers" (Greek); between the Tigris and Euphrates Rivers

Mesopotamia

2. A city and the lands around it, with its own government, not part of a larger state

city-state

3. A curving strip of good farmland from the Mediterranean Sea to the Persian Gulf

Fertile Crescent

4. A government ruled by a king

monarchy

5. A large temple; the name means "to rise high"; the top was the god's home

ziggurat

6. A long poem that tells the story of a hero

epic

7. A name for Mesopotamia: the beginning of organized human society

cradle of civilization

8. A skilled worker who makes things like cloth, pottery, tools, and weapons

artisan

9. An agreement to help each other and protect common interests

alliance

10. An extra amount (of food)

surplus

11. An official record keeper

scribe

12. Passed down in a family: when the king died, his son took over

hereditary

13. Small particles of soil left behind by floods; very good for farming

silt

14. Sumerian writing made of wedge-shaped marks cut into damp clay with a sharp reed

cuneiform

15. Watering crops by digging canals that carry water from a water source to the fields

irrigation

16. Worshipping many gods

polytheism
